

21 Questions to Ask Before You Pay an Inverter Installer in Lagos

A checklist to walk through before you pay anyone for solar, inverter, or battery installation

Most bad installations in Lagos do not fail because the equipment was bad. They fail because nobody asked the right question at the right moment, and the same few problems keep repeating: an installer who disappears after collecting a deposit, a battery sized by guesswork instead of a proper load calculation, or a changeover switch wired wrong so the house has no power even though the inverter itself is “working.” These are the 21 questions that catch those problems before you pay for them.

Print this out and bring it to every conversation with an installer. Tick each box before you agree to move on to the next stage.

Stage 1: Before you call anyone

- ☐ I have a rough list of what I want to power (fridge, AC units, pumps, lights, TV, router) and roughly how many hours a day.
- ☐ I have asked the installer how long they have been installing in Lagos, not just how long the company has existed.
- ☐ I have asked for two phone numbers of past customers I can call myself, not just photos of finished jobs.
- ☐ I have checked whether this is a registered company or one person working alone, so I know which one I am dealing with.

Stage 2: Before you agree to a price

- ☐ The installer has visited, or asked detailed questions about my appliances, instead of quoting a price over the phone based on “how many rooms.”
- ☐ I have seen the load calculation in writing: what I want to run, how many watts that adds up to, and why the inverter and battery size match it.
- ☐ The quote lists the brand and model of every panel, inverter, and battery, not just “inverter” and “battery” as line items.
- ☐ I know whether the price includes wiring, changeover switch, mounting, and labour, or whether those are billed separately.
- ☐ I have gotten at least one other quote to compare, even when I already trust this installer.

Stage 3: Before you pay a deposit

- ☐ The workmanship warranty is written down, including how long it lasts, what it covers if something goes wrong, who comes back to fix it, and whether that costs extra.
- ☐ The payment terms are written somewhere, even a WhatsApp message with dates and amounts, not just agreed by voice.
- ☐ I have the installer’s full name, phone number, and physical address, not just a WhatsApp handle.

Stage 4: On installation day

- ☐ The installer separates my essential circuits (fridge, lights, router) from heavy ones (AC, pumping machine, iron) before wiring the changeover switch.

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- ☐ The cables match the load, since thin, cheap cable on a heavy circuit is a fire risk and not a shortcut worth taking.
- ☐ I can see the brand names on the panels, inverter, and batteries being installed, and they match what was quoted.
- ☐ The battery room or cabinet has ventilation, since batteries sealed into a hot, airless space fail sooner.
- ☐ The installer isolates the circuit before touching any wiring, because that is a basic safety step and not something to skip to save time.

Stage 5: Before you pay the final balance

- ☐ The full system has been tested under load, meaning appliances were switched on and run, not just checked with a quick light bulb test.
- ☐ The installer has shown me how to operate it: what the display means, how to switch between grid and battery, and what to do if something trips.
- ☐ I have the manufacturer warranty documents, not just the installer's word, for the inverter and battery.
- ☐ I have a written record of what was installed, including brands, models, capacity, and the date.

Red flags. Walk away if:

- The installer wants full payment upfront, with no written terms.
- The price changes by a large amount after you have already paid a deposit.
- Nobody can explain, in plain terms, why they chose that inverter and battery size for your load.
- The installer avoids giving you a physical address or a second contact number.
- You are told "it does not need a warranty" or "warranty is not how it works here," since a serious installer offers one anyway.
- The batteries or panels have no visible brand name, or the installer is vague about where they came from.

This checklist was put together by PowerNexa Solutions, based on problems Lagos homeowners describe after a bad installation: installers who disappear, systems sized by guesswork, and wiring that was never tested. If you would rather skip the guesswork, we do a proper load calculation and a written quote before any money changes hands. WhatsApp us at 0813 209 7317 or visit powernexasolutions.site to get started.